

AMELANCHIER

usually woolly when young and turning yellow or red in fall. Star-shaped, white flowers are borne profusely in late spring, followed by edible, juicy, rounded, black-currant-like fruits. Z5–7

A. canadensis. Deciduous, upright, dense shrub. H 20ft (6m), S 10ft (3m). Star-shaped, white flowers are borne from mid-to late spring amid unfolding, ovate, white-haired leaves that mature to dark green and turn orange-red in fall. Fruits are edible, rounded, blackish-purple, sweet, and juicy. Z3–7

A. x grandiflora. Spreading, sometimes shrubby tree. H 25ft (8m), S 30ft (10m). Produces ovate leaves, bronze on emergence, with hairy undersides, turning green in late spring, then orange and red in fall. Pendent racemes of white flowers are produced in midspring, followed by sweet, juicy, blue-black fruit. Z4–9. **‘La Paloma’**, H and S 6ft (2m), forms a large, mounded shrub. Produces very attractive pure white flowers and contrasting coppery young leaves with good fall color. Z4–9. **‘Princess Diana’** bears abundant, pure white flowers with unfolding pale bronze leaves in early spring. **‘Robin Hill’**, H 26ft (8m), S 16ft (5m), is compact and broadly upright, with white flowers and pink-tinged buds.

A. laevis illus. p.81.

A. lamarkii illus. p.110.

Amomyrtus luma. See *Luma apiculata*.
Amomyrtus luma ‘Glanleam Gold’.
See *Luma apiculata* ‘Glanleam Gold’.

AMORPHA

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of deciduous shrubs grown for their flowers and foliage. A useful plant for cold, dry, exposed positions. Requires full sun and well-drained soil. May be propagated by softwood cuttings taken in summer or by seed sown in fall.

A. canescens (Lead plant). Deciduous, open shrub. H 3ft (1m), S 5ft (1.5m). Dense spikes of tiny, pealike, purple flowers, with orange anthers, are produced in late summer and early fall, amid ovate, gray-haired leaves divided into 21–41 narrowly ovate leaflets. Z2–8

AMORPHOPHALLUS

ARACEAE

Genus of tuberous perennials, cultivated for their huge and dramatic, but foul-smelling, spathes, which surround tiny flowers on sturdy spadices. Requires partial shade and humus-rich soil kept continuously moist during the growing season. Keep tubers dry in winter. Propagate by seed sown in spring or by offsets in spring or summer.

A. konjac, syn. *A. rivieri*. Summer-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 3–4½ft (1–1.3m), S 6ft (2m). Produces a flattish, wavy-edged, dark reddish-brown spathe, to 16in (40cm) long, from which protrudes an erect, dark brown spadix. Brownish-green-mottled, pale green stem, 3ft (1m) long, bears one large, lobed leaf after flowering. Z13–15 (min. 55–61°F/13–16°C)

A. rivieri. See *A. konjac*.

AMPELODESMOS

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES AND SEDGES.

A. mauritanicus illus. p.287.

AMPELOPSIS

VITACEAE

Genus of deciduous, woody-stemmed, tendril climbers, some twining, grown for their leaves. Grow in a sheltered site, in sun or partial shade in any soil. Give plenty of room, as grows quickly and covers a large area. Propagate by semiripe or greenwood cuttings in midsummer.

A. aconitifolia, syn. *Vitis aconitifolia*. Fast-growing, deciduous, woody-stemmed, twining, tendril climber. H 40ft (12m). Rounded leaves have toothed, lobed, dark green leaflets. Inconspicuous greenish flowers, in late summer, are followed by orange berries. Z5–8.

A. brevipedunculata, syn. *A. glandulosa*, illus. p.210. **‘Elegans’** illus. p.195. **var. maximowiczii** (syn. *A. heterophylla*, *Vitis heterophylla*) is a deciduous, woody-stemmed, tendril climber. H 70ft (20m). Has very variable leaves, sometimes not lobed and broadly heart-shaped at the bases, sometimes shallowly 3-lobed, or deeply cut into 3–5 lobes. Z5–8.

A. glandulosa. See *A. brevipedunculata*.

A. heterophylla. See *A. brevipedunculata* var. *maximowiczii*.

A. megalophylla illus. p.210.

A. sempervirens. See *Cissus striata*.

A. veitchii. See *Parthenocissus tricuspidata* ‘Veitchii’.

AMSONIA

Blue star

APOCYNACEAE

Genus of slow-growing, clump-forming, summer-flowering perennials. Grow in full sun and in well-drained soil. Best left undisturbed for some years. Propagate by division in spring, by softwood cuttings in summer or by seed in fall. ☉Contact with the milky sap may irritate skin.

A. orientalis, syn. *Rhazya orientalis*, illus. p.270.

A. tabernaemontana (Willow bluestar). Clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 18in (45cm). Leaves are small and narrow. Willowy stems bear drooping clusters of small, tubular, pale blue flowers in summer. Z3–9.

Amygdalus. See *Prunus*.

ANACAMPTIS

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

A. morio, syn. *Orchis morio* (Gandergoose, Green-veined orchid; illus. p.466). Deciduous, terrestrial orchid. H 6–12in (15–30cm). Reddish-purple, mauve or rarely white flowers, ½in (1cm) long, with green veins on cupped sepals, open along stems in spring. Has a basal cluster of lance-shaped or broadly oblong, pale to mid-green leaves, 4–6in (10–16cm) long. Requires sun or semishade. Z12–15.

ANACYCLUS

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of summer-flowering, prostrate annuals and herbaceous perennials with stems radiating from a central rootstock. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by softwood cuttings in spring or by seed in fall.

A. depressus. See *A. pyrethrum* var. *depressus*.

A. pyrethrum var. depressus, syn. *A. depressus*, illus. p.360.

ANAGALLIS

PRIMULACEAE

Genus of creeping or low-growing annuals and evergreen perennials, grown for their flowers. Needs an open, sunny site and fertile, moist soil. Propagate by seed or division in spring. Raise *A. tenella* ‘Studland’ by soft-tip cuttings in spring or early summer.

A. monellii ‘Gentian Blue’. Bushy, compact perennial. H 6in (15cm), S to 16in (40cm). Branching stems bear stalkless, lance-shaped to elliptic leaves in opposite pairs or 3s. Produces deep blue, saucer-shaped flowers, ¾in (1.5cm) across, on long stalks in summer. Z9–11

A. tenella ‘Studland’ illus. p.353.

ANANAS

BROMELIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, rosette-forming perennials, grown for their foliage and edible fruits (pineapples). Prefers full light, but tolerates some shade. Needs fertile, well-drained soil. Water moderately in growth; sparingly at other times. Propagate by suckers or cuttings of “leafy” fruit tops in spring or summer.

A. bracteatus (Red pineapple, Wild pineapple). **‘Tricolor’** (syn. *A.b. ‘Striatus’*, *A.b. var. tricolor*; illus. p.471) is a basal-rosetted, evergreen perennial. H to 28in (70cm), S 20in (50cm). Forms dense rosettes of strap-shaped, spiny-edged, arching, deep green leaves, longitudinally yellow-striped, often with marginal, red spines. Bears dense spikes of small, tubular, lavender-violet flowers with prominent, reddish-pink bracts, usually in summer. Brownish-orange-red fruits are 6in (15cm) or more long. Z15. (min. 59°F/15°C)

A. comosus ‘Variegatus’. Evergreen, basal-rosetted perennial. H 36in (100cm), S 20in (50cm). Very narrowly strap-shaped, channelled, rigid, gray-green leaves are suffused pink with cream margins, gray-scaled beneath, and sometimes have spiny edges. Produces tubular, purple-blue flowers with inconspicuous, green bracts; fruits are the edible pineapples grown commercially, but are much smaller on pot-grown plants. Z11. (min. 59°F/15°C)

ANAPHALIS

Pearl everlasting

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of spreading to upright perennials, some evergreen, with heads of small, papery flowers, used dried for winter decoration. Prefers sun but tolerates

semishade. Soil should be well-drained but not too dry. Propagate by seed in fall or division in winter or spring.

A. margaritacea (Pearl everlasting) illus. p.231.

A. nepalensis var. monocephala, syn. *A. nubigena* of gardens. Dwarf, leafy perennial. H 32–36in (80–90cm), S 18–24in (45–60cm). Woolly, silvery stems bear lance-shaped leaves. In late summer has dense, terminal clusters of white flower heads. Z5–8.

A. nubigena of gardens. See *A. nepalensis* var. *monocephala*.

A. triplinervis. Variable, clump-forming perennial. H 32–36in (80–90cm), S 18–24in (45–60cm). Has obovate to elliptic, white-woolly leaves, prominently 3-veined. In mid- to late summer produces clusters of white-bracted, yellow-centered flower heads. Z5–8. **‘Sommerschnee’** (syn. *A.t. Summer Snow*) illus. p.231.

ANAPHALIOIDES

Pearl everlasting

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of low-growing, alpine subshrubs, grown for their “everlasting” flower heads and silver foliage. Requires full sun and very well drained soil. Propagate by heel or semiripe cuttings in summer.

A. bellidioides, syn. *Helichrysum bellidioides*. Evergreen, prostrate shrub. H 6in (15cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has small, rounded, fleshy, dark green leaves and, in early summer, terminal clusters of daisylike, white flower heads. Z7–9

ANCHUSA

BORAGINACEAE

Genus of annuals, biennials and perennials, some of which are evergreen, usually with blue flowers, which are attractive to bees. Requires sun and well-drained soil; resents too much winter wet. Tall perennial species may need to be staked and given room to spread. Propagate perennials by root cuttings in winter, annuals and biennials by seed in fall or spring.

A. azurea, syn. *A. italica*. **‘Little John’** is a clump-forming perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 12in (30cm). Mainly basal leaves are narrowly ovate and hairy. Bears branching racemes of large, open cup-shaped, dark blue flowers in early summer. **‘Loddon Royalist’** illus. p.241. **‘Opal’**, H 4ft (1.2m), has paler blue flowers. Z3–8.

A. caespitosa. See *A. caespitosa*.

A. capensis ‘Blue Angel’ illus. p.315.

‘Blue Bird’ is a bushy biennial, grown as an annual. H to 18in (45cm), S 6–9in (15–23cm). Has lance-shaped, bristly, mid-green leaves and, in summer, shallowly bowl-shaped, sky-blue flowers. Z7–9.

A. caespitosa, syn. *A. caespitosa*, illus. p.356.

A. italica. See *A. azurea*.

Ancistrocactus. See *Sclerocactus*.

ANDROMEDA

ERICACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs with an open, twiggy habit. Needs full light and humus-rich, moist, acidic soil. Propagate by